

Exception Flow Specification

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Use Case: Generate Audit Export

Primary Actors: Compliance Officer / Security Auditor

System Components: Audit Log Service; Integrity Verification Service

Exception Flow 1 – Audit Log Service Unavailable

Trigger: Main Success Scenario Step 4, when the system attempts to retrieve matching audit records from the audit log store and the Audit Log Service is unavailable.

Step	System/User Action
1	User confirms the audit export request.
2	System attempts to retrieve the matching audit records.
3	Audit Log Service is unavailable or cannot be reached.
4 – Proper message	System aborts the export, logs the failed attempt, and displays: “We’re unable to retrieve audit records right now because the Audit Log Service is temporarily unavailable. No export was generated. Please try again later.”
5	User may retry later. The current use-case attempt ends in failure.

Exception Flow 2 – Authorization Expires or Is Revoked

Step	System/User Action
1	System detects that the user’s authorization has expired or has been revoked during processing.
2	System immediately halts export processing.
3	Any partially generated export is discarded and is not cached or delivered.
4 – Proper message	System denies delivery and displays: “Your authorization to generate this audit export has expired or been revoked. The export was not delivered. Please sign in again or contact your administrator if you believe this is an error.”
5	The failed attempt is logged. The use case ends in failure.

Exception Flow 3 – Export Generation Failure

Step	System/User Action
1	System has retrieved the required records and begins export generation.

2	A formatting, packaging, or storage error occurs.
3	System prevents any partial output from remaining accessible and logs the failure.
4 – Proper message	System displays: “The audit export could not be generated because an internal export-processing error occurred. No incomplete file was delivered. Please retry the export.”
5	User may retry the export. The current use-case attempt ends in failure.

Message Requirements

- Clearly state what happened.
- State whether an export was generated or delivered.
- Give the user a safe next action.
- Do not expose stack traces or sensitive internal implementation details.
- For integrity failures, disclose the excluded record IDs and reasons in the discrepancy report, as required by the existing flow.

Source Consistency

These exception flows follow the existing specification: E1 aborts the export and notifies the user of a temporary system error; E2 halts processing and discards any partial export; E3 retains no accessible partial output, logs the failure, and prompts the user to retry.